

# Guide to Buying a Home



## Know Your Budget

Assess your income, debts, and down payment, and use a mortgage calculator to estimate monthly payments and set a realistic budget, including property taxes, homeowners insurance, and HOA and CDD fees.

## Get Mortgage Pre-Approval or Proof of Funds

A pre-approval letter (or proof of funds if paying cash) shows sellers you're serious and speeds up the process. If buying cash, have a bank statement ready to show a potential seller.

## Understand Your Needs

Identify your must-have features, such as the number of bedrooms or proximity to schools. Prioritize what's most important to you.

## Determine If You Need to Sell Your Current Home

If applicable, decide upfront whether your purchase depends on selling your current home first. This matters because most sellers won't accept an offer contingent on the sale of another property, so knowing where you stand shapes your timeline and your offer strategy.

## Hire a Real Estate Agent

A knowledgeable agent can guide you through the process, research neighborhood trends and property values on your behalf, negotiate for you, and help you avoid costly mistakes. From there, start scheduling showings and attending open houses to see what's really out there.

## Make an Offer

Once you find a home, work with your agent to submit a competitive offer. Consider the market conditions when deciding on your price, hot markets may lead to bidding wars, while cold markets may put a buyer in a position of strength.

## Schedule a Home Inspection

A professional inspection can identify hidden issues and may save you money on repairs or help with negotiations. Best of all, you can cancel at any time during the inspection period and get your deposit back, no questions asked.

## Understanding Homeowners Associations (HOAs)

Not every home comes with an HOA, so it's worth deciding early whether that lifestyle is right for you. If it is, understand the true cost what the dues actually cover, from amenities to maintenance, so there are no surprises after closing.

## Plan for Ongoing Costs

Remember that homeownership includes maintenance, utilities, and potential repairs. Budget for these ongoing expenses.



*Ready to make your move?*

Reach out to me today to create a personalized plan and ensure every step of your journey is seamless and stress-free.

**Let's make your home goals a reality!**



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